LECTURE 2

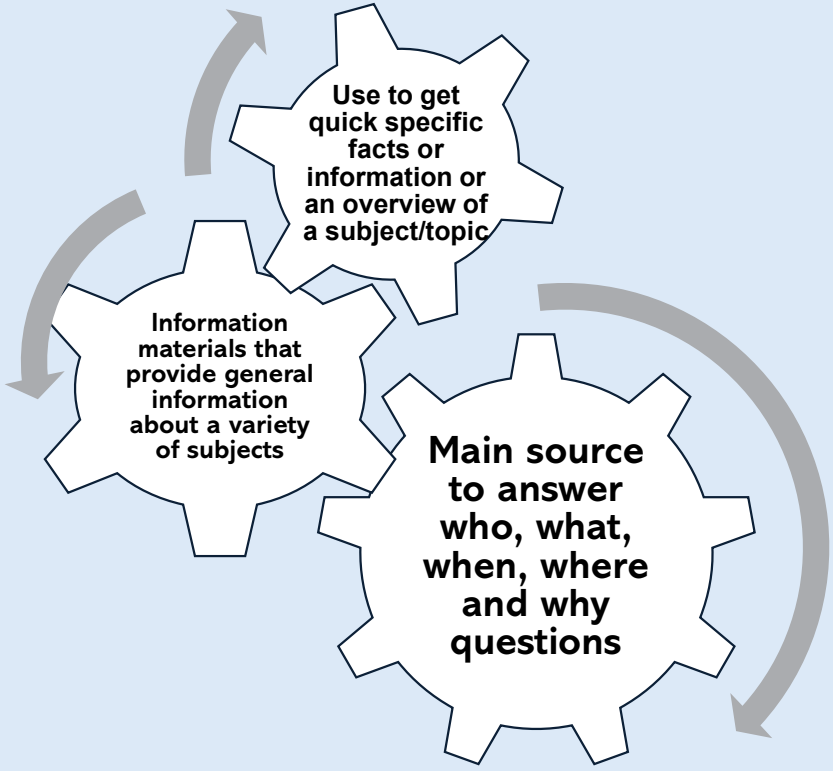
Basic References

GBX0009

INFORMATION SEEKING, WRITING & ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

User Education Section, UM Library

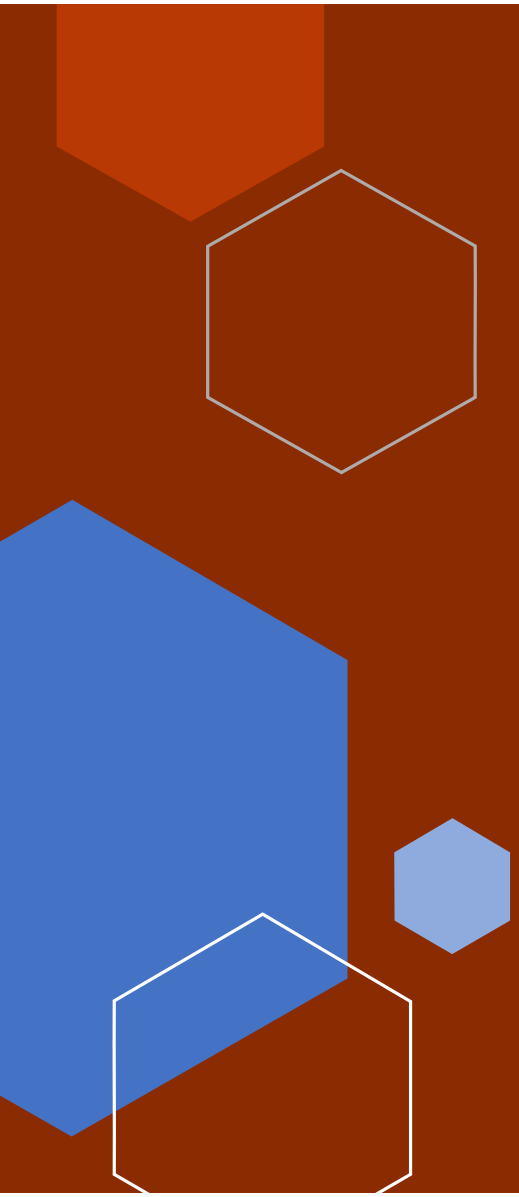
What are Basic References?



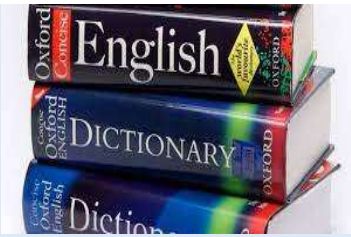
Use basic references to find resources that provide:

- A broad overview of the topic
- Definitions of the topic
- Introduction to key issues or ideas
- Names of individuals, organizations or that are experts in the subject field
- Major dates and events
- Keyword and subject specific vocabulary terms that can be used in a database
- Bibliographies that lead to additional resources



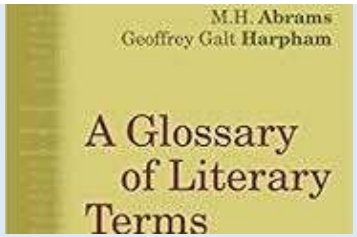


Basic Reference Types



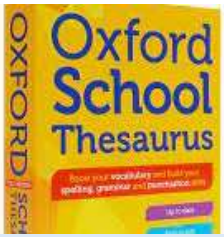
DICTIONARY

- A list of the words of a language and gives their meaning, or gives the equivalent words in a different language, providing information about pronunciation, origin, and usage
- *Language Dictionary* - gives definition of words or translation of words in other language,
  - One-language
  - Bilingual
  - Polyglot
- *Subject Dictionary* - contains alphabetically ordered terms relating to a subject or topic
- *Glossary* - an alphabetical list of technical terms in some specialized field of knowledge



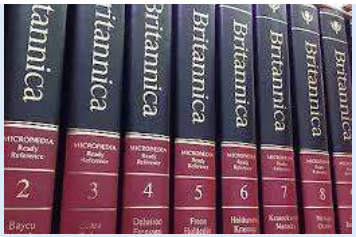
GLOSSARY

- A list of terms in a special subject, field, or area of usage, with accompanying definitions
- A list of terms at the back of a book, explaining or defining difficult or unusual words and expressions used in the text



THESAURI

- A dictionary of synonyms and antonyms



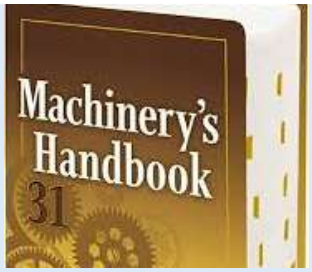
ENCYCLOPEDIA

- Contains articles on various topics, usually in alphabetical arrangement, covering all branches of knowledge or, less commonly, all aspects of one subject
- Definition, description, brief explanation, background, history
- *General encyclopedia* - topics relating to various matters such as people, events, places, terms & etc.
- *Subject encyclopedia* - topics relating to a certain subject



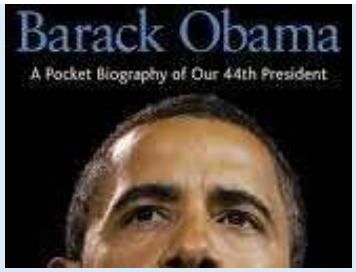
DIRECTORY

- Index of the names and addresses of persons in a city, district, organization, etc., or of a particular category of people



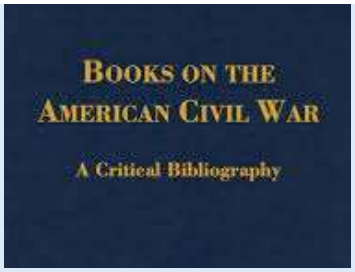
HANDBOOK

- a book of instruction or guidance, as for an occupation; manual
- a guidebook for travellers
- a reference book in a particular field/subject



BIOGRAPHY

- a written about a person's life
- Biography – written by another person
- Autobiography - written by that person him/herself



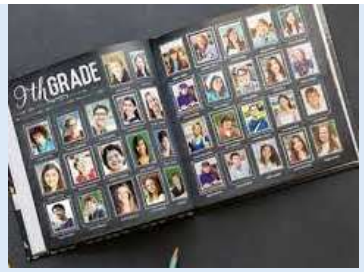
BIBLIOGRAPHY

- A list of resources on a particular subject
- Provide full reference information for all the sources that have been used in writing (research, books, articles, etc)
- a bibliography will guide you to locate specific resources used



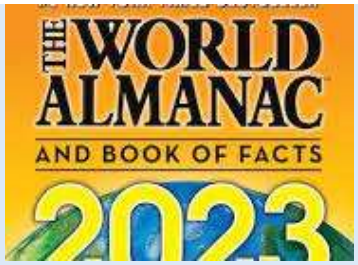
ANNUAL REPORT

- a document reporting to stockholders on management and operations and containing fiscal information, published yearly by a publicly held corporation as required by federal law



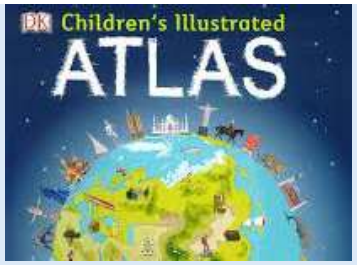
YEARBOOK

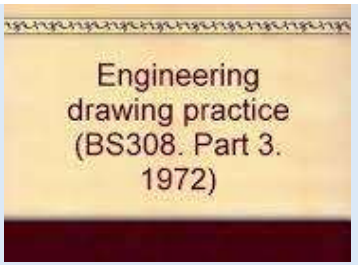
- a book published annually, containing information, statistics, etc., about the past year
- a book published by the graduating class of a high school or college, containing photographs of class members and commemorating school activities











ALMANAC

- an annual publication containing a calendar for the coming year, the times of such events and phenomena as anniversaries, sunrises and sunsets, phases of the moon, tides, etc., and other statistical information and related topics
- a publication containing astronomical or meteorological information, usually including future positions of celestial objects, star magnitudes, and culmination dates of constellations

STATISTIC

- a numerical facts or data on specific subjects

GAZETTEER

- a geographical dictionary or directory, an important reference for information about places and place names used in conjunction with a map or a full atlas.
- It typically contains information concerning the geographical makeup of a country, region, or continent as well as the social statistics and physical features, such as mountains, waterways, or roads

ATLAS

- a bound collection of maps or chart

STANDARD

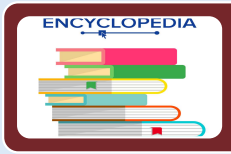
- Guidelines that discuss the level of quality used as a measure for the assessment quality of achievement
- Used as measures, norms, or models in comparative assessment

Web/Online Resources



Directory

- https://doctors.demodirectory.com/
- https://curlie.org/



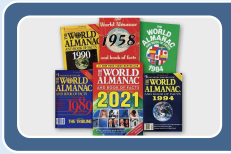
Encyclopedia

- http://www.britannica.com/
- http://www.merriam-webster.com/



Dictionary/Thesaurus

- http://dictionary.reference.com/
- http://thesaurus.reference.com/



Almanac

- https://www.almanac.com/
- https://www.infoplease.com/



Statistics

- https://www.dosm.gov.my/
- https://data.worldbank.org/

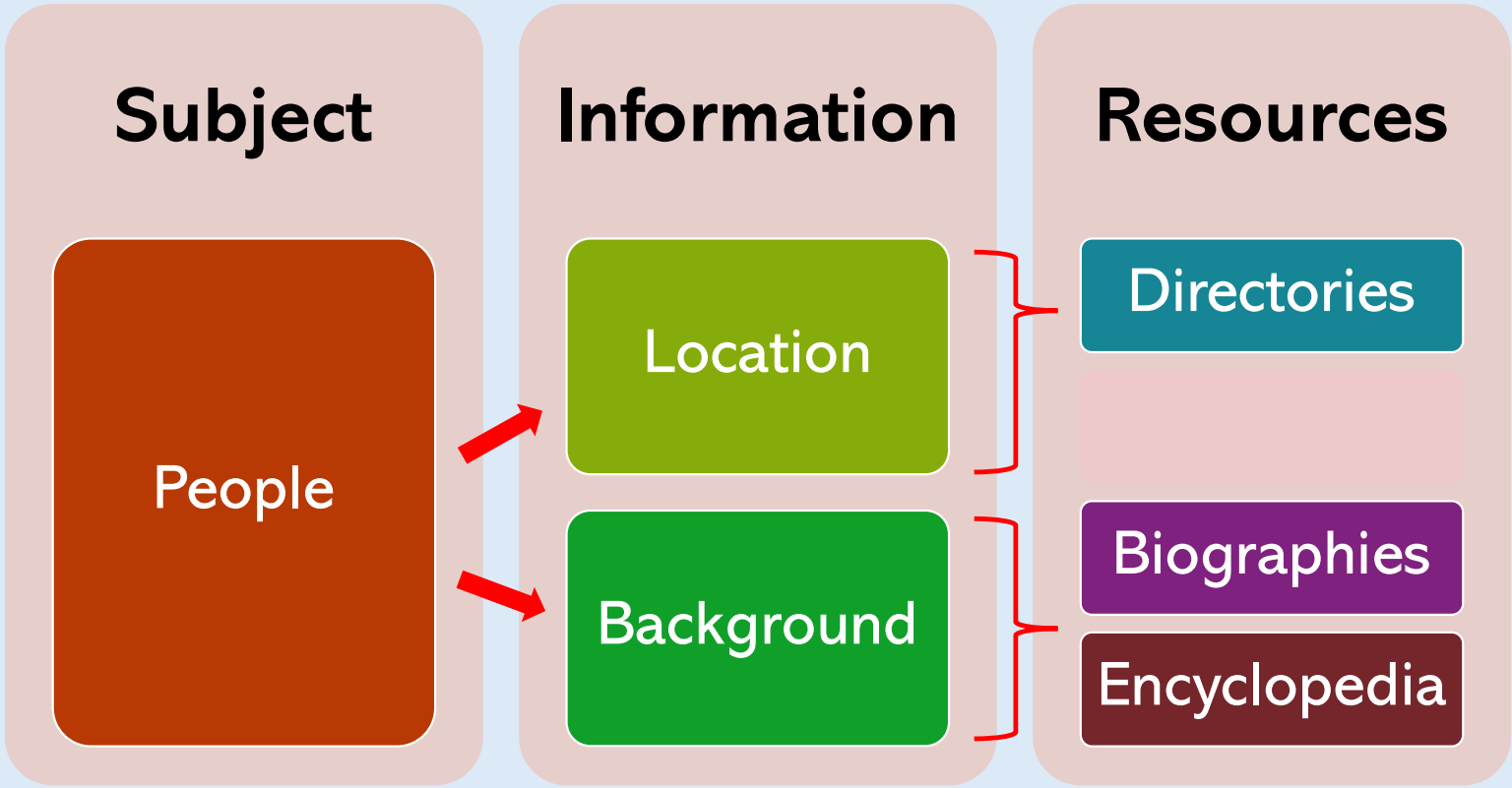


Standards

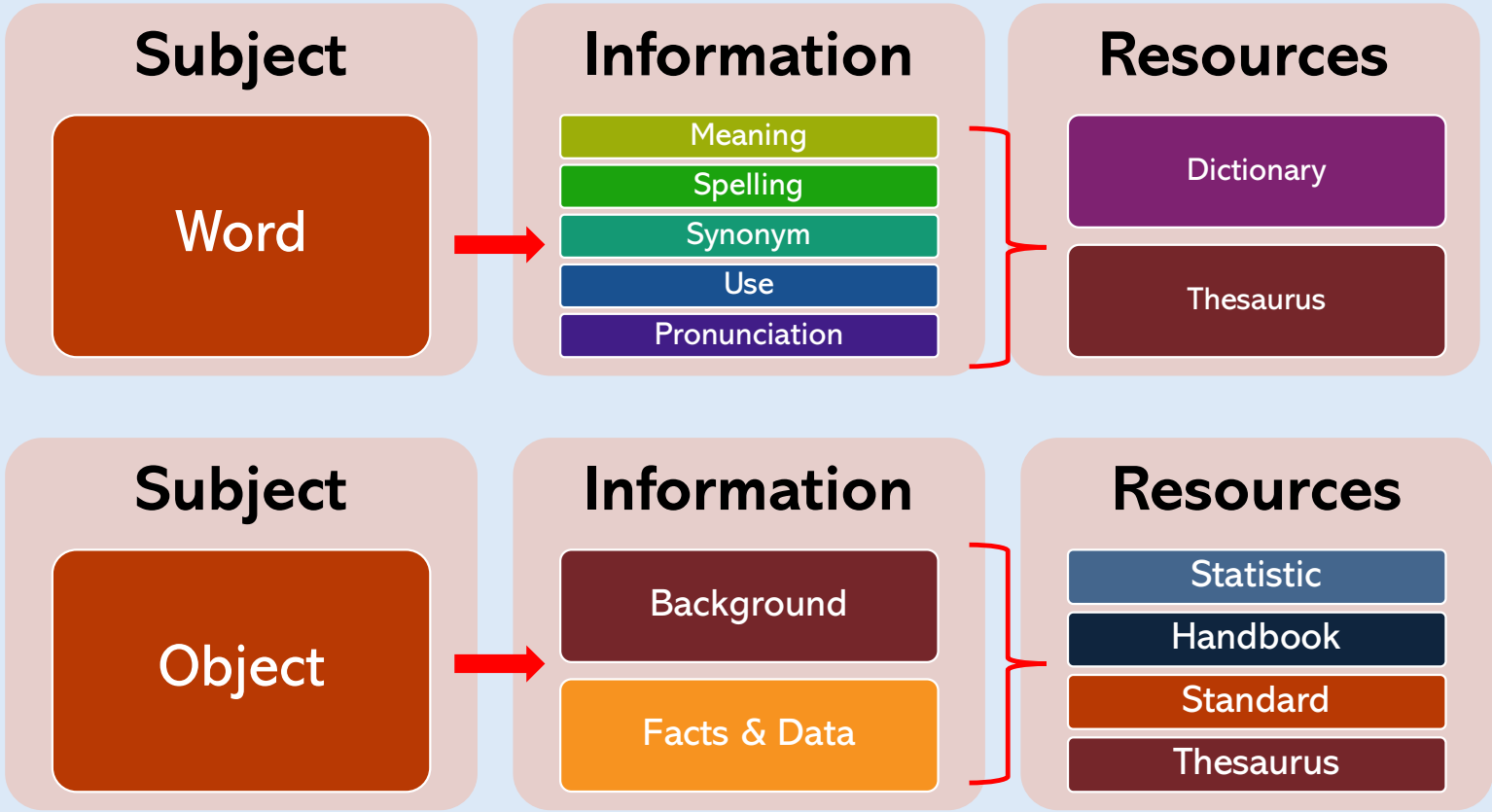
- https://www.iso.org/standards.html
- https://www.astm.org/

Guide to Identifying Reference Materials

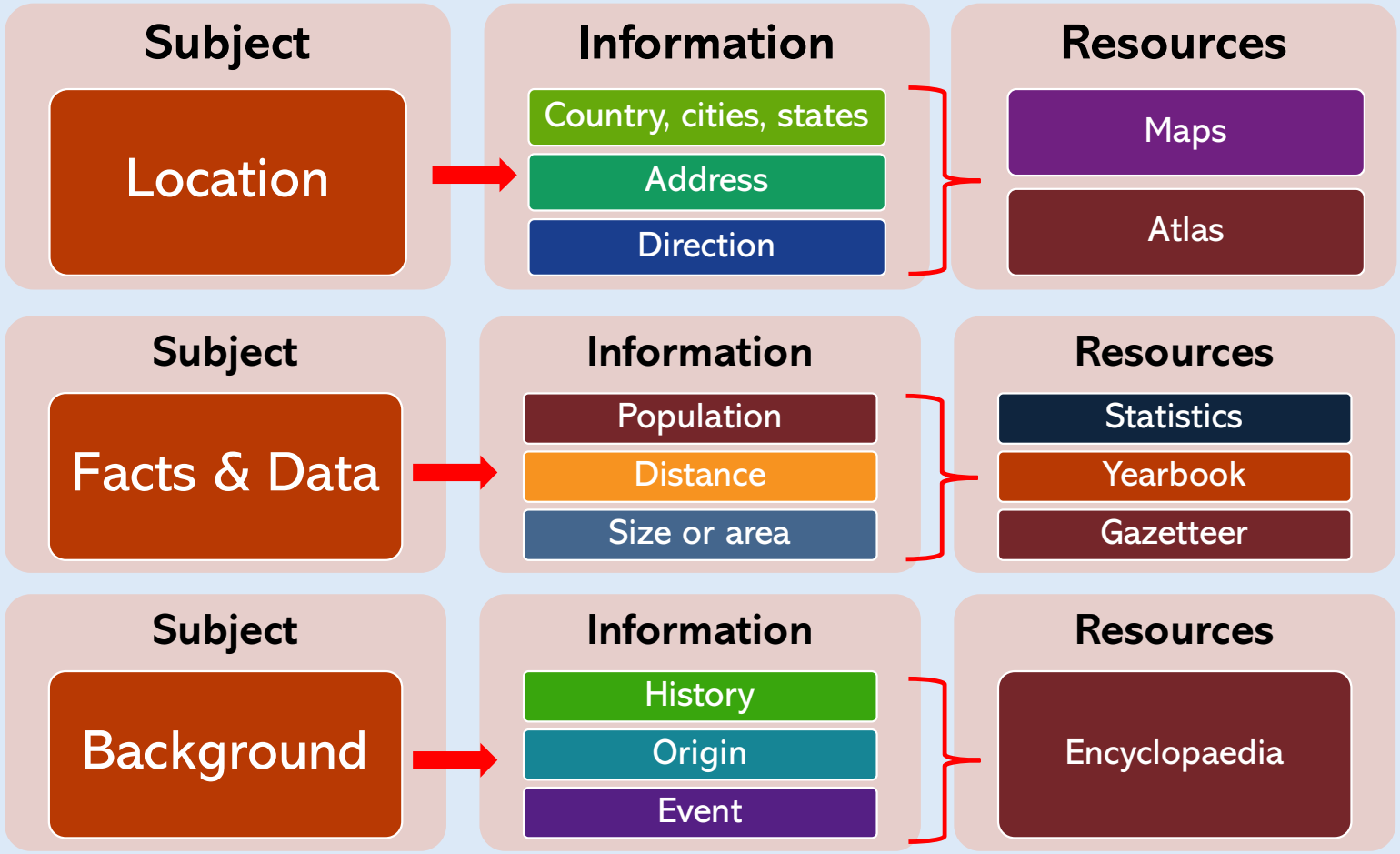
Who?


Subject
Information
Resources
People
Location
Background
Directories
Biographies
Encyclopedia

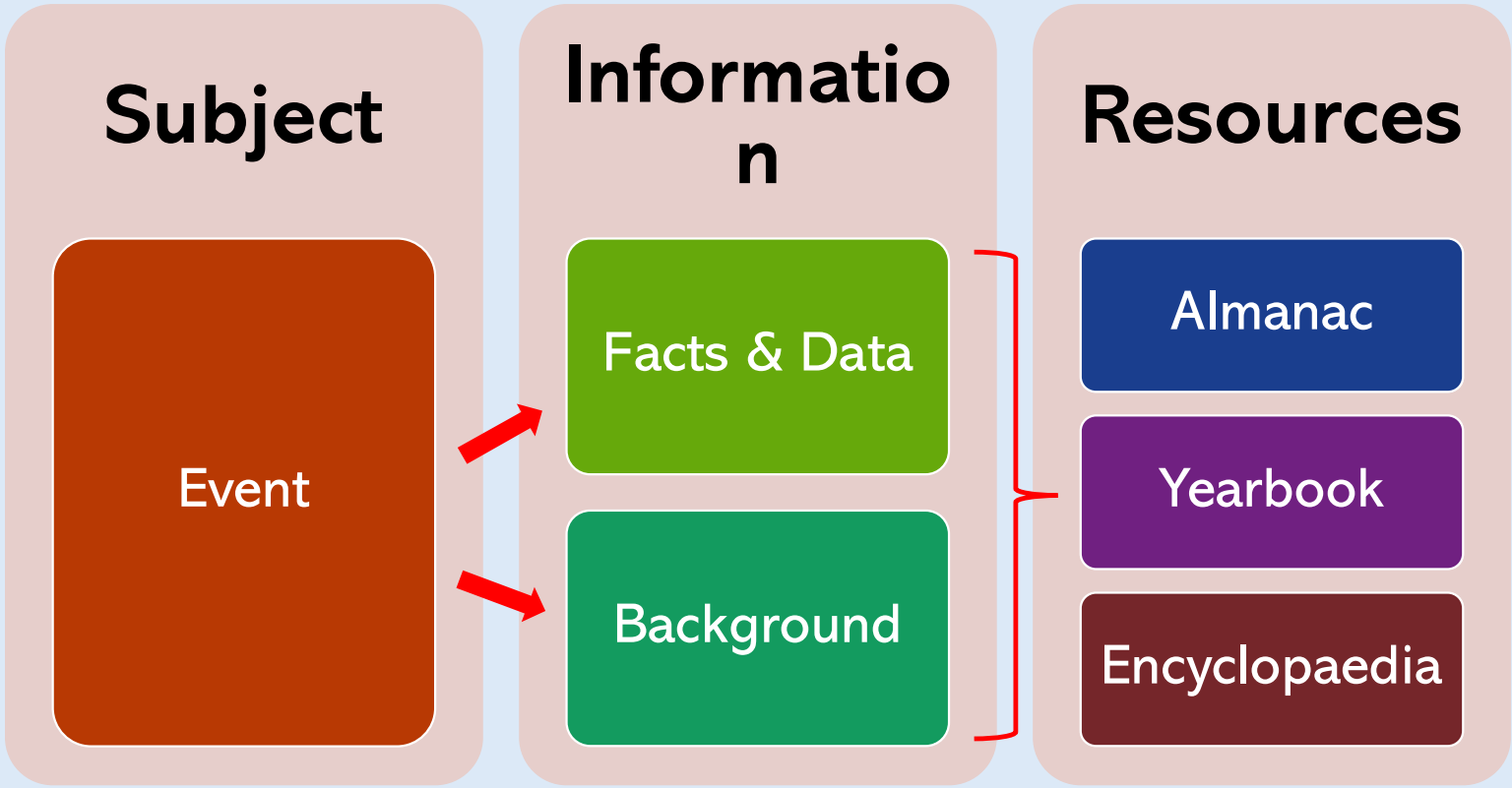
What?


Subject
Word
Information
Meaning
Spelling
Synonym
Use
Pronunciation
Resources
Dictionary
Thesaurus
Subject
Object
Information
Background
Facts & Data
Resources
Statistic
Handbook
Standard
Thesaurus

Where?


Subject
Location
Information
Country, cities, states
Address
Direction
Resources
Maps
Atlas
Subject
Facts & Data
Information
Population
Distance
Size or area
Resources
Statistics
Yearbook
Gazetteer
Subject
Background
Information
History
Origin
Event
Resources
Encyclopaedia

When?


Subject
Event
Information
Facts & Data
Background
Resources
Almanac
Yearbook
Encyclopaedia


Thank you